



More of the **SAME**

Made in the shadow of encounter deaths, Manmohan Singh's predictable offer for talks runs into demands for repeal of the Armed Forces Special Powers Act

By Aijaz Hussain

For decades now, prime ministerial visits to Jammu and Kashmir have centred around announcing liberal economic packages and attempting to bring the separatist leadership into the political mainstream. But there is still an acknowledgement that declining militancy and gradual economic development in the state have not entirely neutralised the separatist sentiment. Last week, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh visited Kashmir for the third time in six years but it was a visit that offered